forces. The action of exogenic forces results in wearing down the rock and hence, they are considered as land wearing forces.

4.2 Exogenic Processes

The processes which occur on earth's surface due to the influence of external forces are called as exogenic processes. Weathering, mass wasting and denudation are the major exogenic processes. The elements of nature capable of doing these exogenic processes are termed as gradational agents. For instance, the wind, river, glacier, waves and ground water.

4.3 Weathering

Weathering is the process of disintegration and decomposition of rocks. It is due to the action of climate, plants, animals and other living organisms which cause the rocks to break down physically, chemically and biologically.

There are three types of weathering. They are physical weathering, chemical weathering and biological weathering.

4.3.1 Physical weathering

Physical Weathering is the disintegration of rock mainly induced by elements of weather. It produces smaller, angular fragments of the same rock. It is caused by the change in temperature, pressure, water and wind. Physical weathering is further divided into different categories. They are thermal weathering, frost wedging and exfoliation.

4.3.1.1 Thermal weathering

In arid and semi-arid areas, the temperature increases, heat up and expand the rocks during the day and contract the rock materials when cooling at night. Under extreme temperature conditions, due to alternate expansion and contraction, the rocks crack and eventually split. The thermal weatherings are of two types. They are;

(a) Granular disintegration and
(b) Block disintegration

Granular disintegration

Alternate expansion and contraction of minerals of varying properties in the

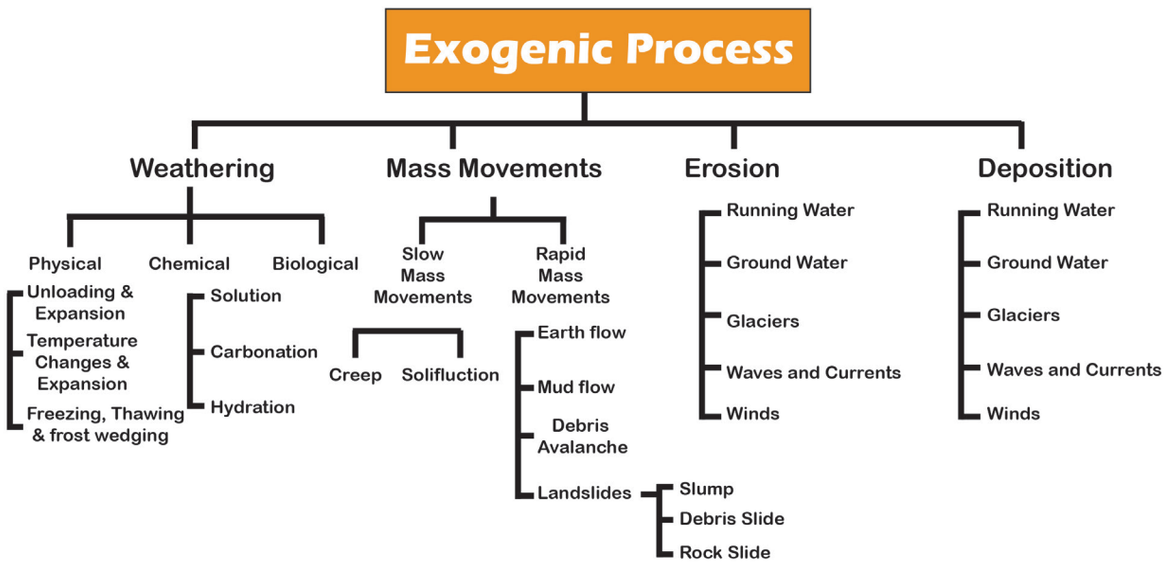


Figure 4.1 Exogenic processes

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